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UK Import Checklist

Before your first shipment to Great Britain

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1. Set-up

- [ ] Agree who is the importer of record (your company, a UK subsidiary or your buyer) and the Incoterms (DAP or DDP)
- [ ] Apply for a GB EORI number for the importer on GOV.UK
- [ ] Check whether you need UK VAT registration (for example under DDP or when selling to UK customers)
- [ ] If VAT-registered, plan to use postponed VAT accounting for import VAT

2. Products

- [ ] Find the commodity code for every product in the UK Integrated Online Tariff
- [ ] Note the duty rate and any import controls attached to each code
- [ ] Check rules of origin and whether a UK trade agreement (for example with the EU or Turkey) gives reduced or zero duty
- [ ] Check conformity marking (UKCA, or CE where still accepted), UK labelling and any licences
- [ ] Food, plant and animal products: check health certificates and IPAFFS pre-notification

3. Documents

- [ ] Commercial invoice with value, currency and Incoterms
- [ ] Packing list with cartons, weights and dimensions
- [ ] Transport document: bill of lading, CMR or air waybill
- [ ] Proof of origin if claiming a preferential tariff
- [ ] Product certificates or licences where your goods require them

4. Shipping and clearance

- [ ] Appoint a freight forwarder or customs agent to lodge the declaration in CDS
- [ ] Budget for customs duty (paid on release) and import VAT (usually 20% on the value including duty)
- [ ] Confirm the arrival port and the delivery booking at the warehouse

5. Warehouse

- [ ] Send the packing list and SKU details to the warehouse before arrival
- [ ] Agree how goods arrive: palletised, or loose-loaded for container unloading
- [ ] Agree storage, order and distribution requirements, and how stock will be reported

> This checklist is general guidance, not legal or tax advice. Check GOV.UK for your product category and take professional advice before the first shipment.

Need storage, freight or customs clearance? Request a quote at www.londradepo.com/en/request-a-quote